

Request for Proposal Compensation Study



The City of Villa Rica, Georgia, ("City") is requesting proposals for consulting services to conduct a City-wide Compensation Study as described herein.

Goals and Objectives: The purpose of the Compensation Study is to address changes in City staffing over the past years, which may have affected the level of compensation and work being performed.

City of Villa Rica Profile:

Is a city in Carroll and Douglas counties in the U.S. state of Georgia, located roughly 30 miles west of Atlanta. The city has a residential population estimated at 16,058 in 2019. The city operates under a council-manager form of government with an appointed City Administrator and an elected Mayor. The City is divided into five wards with one councilperson elected from each ward to serve staggered four-year terms.

The city has within its structure, six functional departments, which are: Administration, Community Development & Building Maintenance, Economic Development, Public Safety, Public Works, and Recreation. The City Administrator serves as the Chief Executive Officer with department heads reporting to the City Administrator or the Deputy City Administrator. The city currently has 183 employees of which 163 are full-time, FY 2023 total adopted budget of \$7,717,449 which includes a 5% Cost of Living Increase for all employees.

The city has 123 unique positions currently organized within a salary structure with 33 salary ranges. The current system was created in 2018 when the last salary study was completed.

The City's Objectives:

1. Attract and retain qualified employees.
2. Ensure positions performing similar work with essentially the same level of complexity, responsibility, and knowledge, skills, and abilities are classified together.
3. Provide salaries commensurate with assigned duties.
4. Clearly outline promotional opportunities and provide recognizable compensation growth.
5. Maintain a competitive position with other comparable government entities and private employers within the same geographic areas.
6. Ensure current job descriptions, responsibilities are current and in line with the needs of the Organization.

All work will be done with regular involvement of the City Manager, Deputy City Manager, the Finance Director, and the Human Resource Director. Department Heads and other key personnel will be involved as necessary. Regular presentations and meetings with these individuals or groups, incorporating their

input into the process, are expected. Presentation to the City Council upon completion of the project is also expected.

The study shall evaluate the present salary structure as compared to the specific job market for comparable positions in the public sector. The consultant shall perform or provide the following:

Scope of Services:

1. Conduct a comprehensive benchmark market analysis of all City positions with comparable and surrounding (regional) jurisdictions, institutions of higher education, and applicable private/public sector competitors.
2. Identify potential pay compression issues and provide potential solutions.
3. Review existing position descriptions to ensure current and accurate Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) exemption status, essential functions, minimum qualifications for education and experience, required knowledge, skills, and abilities, special requirements, and physical and environmental conditions; Update the descriptions as needed.
4. Gain an understanding of the City's existing classification, grouped positions and compensation structure and revise where needed.
5. Review all background materials including, but not limited to, existing salary scale, organizational charts, classification specifications, etc.
6. Perform a pay compression analysis of all City positions.

Informational Meetings:

1. Consultant to schedule an initial meeting with City Manager, Deputy City Manager, Finance Director, and Human Resources Director to discuss the process and tasks to be performed in the study to include reasonable dedication of key personnel.
2. Consultant to meet with department heads to explain study and process to be used.
3. Consultant to provide frequent updates to Human Resources Director, point of contact.

Compensation Study:

1. Consultant to review current compensation plan (salary grade levels and steps) and understand current challenges in recruiting and retaining employees.
2. Consultant to recommend and identify a consistent and competitive market position that the city can strive to maintain.
3. Consultant to recommend comparable labor markets, including both private and public-sector employers for compensation survey.
4. Consultant to develop and conduct a comprehensive compensation and benefits survey.
5. Consultant to recommend appropriate salary range for each position based on the classification plan, the compensation survey results, and the internal relationships and equality. Prepare a new salary structure based on the results of the survey and best practices.
6. Consultant to develop guidelines to assist City staff with determining the starting pay for new employees based on knowledge and experience above the minimum requirements of the position, how difficult the position is to fill, and market competitiveness.

7. Consultant to identify any extreme current individual or group compensation inequities and to provide a recommended corrective action plan and process to remedy these situations.
8. Consultant to make recommendations and to provide implementation strategies related to other key compensation practices, based on market demands, including pay for performance, skill pay, special assignment pay, certification pay, bilingual pay, promotional pay, and acting assignment pay.
9. Consultant to provide system documentation and computer formats/software to administer compensation plan.
10. Consultant to provide recommendations for the ongoing internal administration and maintenance of the proposed compensation plan. Maintenance should include annual activities such as market survey.
11. The city will provide copies of all pay ranges, job classifications, and any other available in-house information requested by the selected consultant that may be required to complete the study.

Proposal Format and Requirements:

The offeror shall submit one original (conspicuously marked "ORIGINAL"), five complete copies, and one CD or memory stick of their written proposal that presents their qualifications and understanding of the work to be performed. Include all information requested, organized in tabbed sections clearly identified in a table of contents as described in the paragraphs that follow. Any other information thought to be relevant, but not applicable to the enumerated categories, may be provided as a separate appendix to the proposal. The following information/documents shall be included in the proposal package to be considered responsive to the Request for Proposals:

A. Agents and Address

Identify who will be the project manager and key staff assigned if awarded. Provide resumes summarizing the qualifications and experience of the individuals who will be conducting the study. Include specific information on the staff's experience with public sector compensation including public safety. Describe successful outcomes, list the address, e-mail address, and telephone number of the office from which the services are to be provided. Promotional literature and other public relations documents should NOT be included.

B. Statement of Methods and Procedures

Provide a statement describing the scope of work as you understand it. Describe the approach, means, methods, and procedures to be used to gather the data, analyze findings, and develop recommendations as requested. Provide a sample of reports and/or other correspondence.

C. Management Synopsis

Provide a synopsis prepared for management review, covering the significant features of the proposal including overall costs and term of work.

D. Structure and Content of Work Product

Provide a detailed breakdown and description of the specific steps, services, and study products that will be provided. Describe how the final product will be structured and presented upon completion. Include any computer/software compatibility information. Firms may elect to include in the section any innovative methods or concepts that might be beneficial to the City of Villa Rica as long as the minimum requirements set out in this RFP are met.

E. Work Schedule

Provide a timeline indicating tasks required and the start and completion dates for each. It is expected that the work will commence as soon as possible after the contract is awarded.

F. References

Include the name, address, telephone number, and e-mail address for contact persons at three (3) other public entities for which comparable services have recently been rendered. Please provide a short summary of the project with each reference.

G. Cost of Services

Total fee with cost breakdown, including hourly rates. Estimate the total hours or work need based off the scope of services. Standard payment schedule.

H. Final Product

- a. Provide a statement that the proposer agrees to:
 1. Deliver at least one (1) original, five (5) copies, and a flash drive of the final report to the City Manager
 2. Provide the final report, tables, schedules, charts, spreadsheets, salary surveys, and other materials necessary for the implementation and maintenance of the compensation/classification system in an electronic medium (flash drive); and
 3. Appear at a scheduled Council meeting to discuss the recommendations and final report.
 4. Additional Services (Optional)
- b. Provide any other related and recommended products or service not specified in the RFP which may be considered essential or beneficial by the firm. These services should be priced separately from "G" above and shown here.

I. Other

1. The complete (all pages) Request for Proposal documents with any addenda acknowledgements filled out, initialed, and signed as required. The person that signs the RFP shall have the authority to negotiate the full scope of services on behalf of the organization and shall be authorized to bind the contract to the terms and conditions of this RFP.
2. The classification and compensation system to be recommended as responses to this RFP must adhere to the following basic elements and characteristics: (a) the system must meet all legal requirements, (b) be totally nondiscriminatory and provide for compliance with all pertinent federal, state, and local requirements (e.g., ADA, FLSA, EEO, etc.).
 - i. The system must be easy for management to administer, maintain, and defend.
 - ii. The system must easily accommodate organizational changes and growth.
 - iii. The system should be based on sound compensation principles in which internal and external equity are considered within the pay structure, as well as the concepts of equal pay for equal work, equal pay for similar work, and equal pay for comparable work.
 - iv. The system should provide for new positions to be incorporated into the compensation plan, as well as regular adjustments to maintain the plan's competitiveness.
 - v. The system should be compatible with current City of Villa Rica payroll programs/software.

- vi. The city requests that all information submitted by the successful consulting firm be in electronic format (Word, Excel) on CD, flash drive, and in hard copy. The city further requests the complete use of the material developed for the ability to update or change it as needed. All work provided by the consultant under contract with the City of Villa Rica shall belong exclusively to the City.

Cost Proposal

This request for information does not, under any circumstance, commit the City to pay any costs incurred by any proposer in the submission of qualifications. The proposer is responsible for all costs associated with response to this request.

General Information is on the city's website-www.villarica.org. The City of Villa Rica's current budget can be found on the city's website.

Addenda

It is the proposer's responsibility to check the website for any addenda. Go to www.villarica.org.

Criteria and Selection

After city staff has reviewed the proposals, final selection will be determined. The successful contractor will be required to enter into an agreement for professional services with the City of Villa Rica.

All proposals must be delivered to the city no later than February 23, 2023. Proposals must be delivered to the City of Villa Rica, Attn.: Lena Taylor, HR Director. 571 West Bankhead Highway. Villa Rica, GA 30180. Proposers will be responsible for delivery of their proposals to the City before the deadline. Any proposal received after the deadline will not be considered.

The City of Villa Rica reserves the right to reject any or all proposals at any time with no penalty and to waive immaterial defects and minor irregularities in proposals.

The evaluation of proposals will be done by City personnel who will then forward a recommendation to the City Council for consideration. Fee proposals, which are to be submitted with the qualification proposal will also be taken into consideration. The duration of this consultant agreement has not been determined. The City of Villa Rica does not discriminate on the basis of race, creed, color, ethnicity, national origin, sex, age or marital status.

Any proposals received are the property of City of Villa Rica.

Any questions should be submitted via email to Lena Taylor, HR Director, ltaylor@villarica.gov.